

Research Moodle theming and configuration approaches for the proposed UX redesign

Project: Building an Editor Academy Moodle Platform (Team 74, OAPA)

Client: Open Access Publishing Association (open-publishing.org)

Owner: Dev 1, Reshan Lahandapura

Sprint: Sprint 1, Week 1

note: since we dont have sandbox access to moodle yet this is purely a research task currently. This research considers Moodle-supported approaches that are relevant to the proposed OAPA Academy UX redesign focusing on:

- Navigation
- visual styling
- Course presentation
- learner experience

Navigation

Regarding navigation, while there is navigation between different parts of the course both on the side bar and on the course pages themselves, the pages themselves on the bottom have no "go to next or behind" buttons and and only can navigate from the side bar, a better approach to this would be allowing users with the extra option to go back one book or module aand go forward one book or module through via a button as an addition on the page that co exists with the side bar in order to make navigating through course materials much more simpler and easier.

Visual Styling

For visual styling to improve in the aspect of being clear, some changes that could be made for example the calendar and its elements could be a different color on light mode as currently the background and the Calander is the same color making it somewhat harder to look at with there being no proper contrast so making it a different colour that complements white would visibly levitate the experience of using the calendar when interacting with it, there is a similar case with the course display in the "display courses" section where the bottom half would be the same color as the background so adding a hover element to change color when hovered over or in general just having the white changes would be beneficial.

Course Presentation

To improve the course presentation experience the cards could instead of having a % completed in text it could have a progress bar to better present the progress done, further more instead of assignments being located in activities it could be located on a tab on the top to be better accessible and on the right side bar additionally any work that is due soon could be listed there just as a reminder for students to always keep track of on the front page

Learner Experience

The current learner experience with getting the information is through moodle books, they are very text heavy and are not very engaging in the current state .to make this learning process more interactive Instead of big text blocks information could be put into different slides which learners can read and use h5p to include short knowledge checks in each slide that have to be completed with a successful result in order to be able to go the next slide to ensure that learners actually can engage in some sort of activity to ensure that they understand the knowledge they just read instead of just clicking through them.

Additionally on top of this after the check, if the learner struggled in a particular area they would be told what they struggled with and where to find information in the course they read from so they can go back and read up on the content they need to work on to ensure that they further engage with the content on the learning modules.

Potential implementation constraints

- Ensuring H5P quiz are configured in a way that it cannot be cheated through some sort of bypassing or anything like that

information that will need to be verified against the client environment once access becomes available.

- Whether or not the log in details provided to the environment work and are valid
- Confirming that access is read only upon initial access as editable sandbox access comes later